

ADVICE TO YOUR YOUNGER SELF

Be fearless but also be kind to yourself

MANTRA TO NAVIGATE CHALLENGES

Try new things and improve the old

STEADY HAND

DAISY CHITTILAPILLY loves taking challenges head-on, and as President of Cisco India & SAARC over the past three years, she has been through a roller-coaster ride. Under her, India has emerged as one of the best-performing markets globally for the company, with Cisco setting up its first manufacturing unit in Chennai in September, eyeing ₹11,000 crore annually in exports and domestic production. "We have all learnt to survive and thrive in such an environment, and I am also a leader who has done this," says Chittilapilly. Now that the testing times are past, Cisco is busy launching a suite of products in India. **BT**

— BY **RICHA SHARMA**



DAISY CHITTILAPILLY
51, President, Cisco India & SAARC



DEEPIKA PADUKONE
38, Actor & Entrepreneur

Screen Magic

Bollywood superstar Deepika Padukone has excelled as both an actress and a savvy entrepreneur. Her entrepreneurial journey began in 2014 with KA Enterprises, a family office dedicated to investing in start-ups. With an eye for innovation, she has backed diverse ventures such as BluSmart, Blue Tokai, Epigamia, and Furlenco. Padukone has also increased her stakes in select portfolio companies, including Epigamia and Nua. In 2021, Padukone co-founded DPKA Universal Consumer Ventures Pvt. Ltd with her father, former badminton champion Prakash Padukone. Their skincare line, 82°E, underscores her passion for wellness and self-care. **BT**

— BY **PALAK AGARWAL**

WHY SHE MATTERS

Padukone is a savvy investor and has backed diverse ventures such as BluSmart, Blue Tokai, Epigamia, and Furlenco. She also co-founded DPKA Universal Consumer Ventures Pvt. Ltd with her father, which has the skincare line 82°E

IT'S ALL ABOUT THE PREMIUM

AT THE AGE of 24, Devita Saraf started Vu Group, manufacturing premium TVs, and is today the biggest Indian-owned player in the world, taking on global giants like Sony, Samsung, and LG.

Saraf, who calls her approach to business

old school, took a decision to completely do away with the 32-inch TV segment, where its competitors launched more products, dropping price points and reducing profits.

"This was the biggest financial decision we took in the last

ADVICE TO YOUR YOUNGER SELF

Plan your personal finance at an early age and build your corpus

MANTRA TO NAVIGATE CHALLENGES

Don't make big decisions in a fragile frame of mind



DEVITA SARAF
43, Chairperson & CEO, Vu Group

PHOTO BY **MILIND SHELTE**